MERCER MED TECH

Learner Handbook

Digital Literacy Training

Version 1.2, October 5, 2026

Mercer Med Tech Inc. (MMT). Version 1.2, October 5, 2026.

1. Welcome

Welcome to Digital Literacy Training at Mercer Med Tech. You already use technology every day, on your phone, at the store, and with your benefits. This program builds on what you know. In 7 weeks you will use a laptop, Microsoft 365 and Google tools, email, video meetings, online banking and AI tools the way employers expect. You will also finish a resume, a cover letter and a job search plan, and take the NJIT course that leads to a college credential.

The program costs you nothing. It is for New Jersey adults who receive WorkFirst NJ TANF or SNAP benefits and live in Hunterdon, Mercer, Middlesex, Monmouth, Ocean, Somerset or Union County.

2. Your schedule

When	What happens
Day 0	Orientation. You sign your Individual Employment Plan (IEP). Then you make your Digital Literacy Plan, get your laptop (and a hotspot if you need one), and get your Moodle login.
Week 1, day 1	A live orientation, on campus only: Suite 140, 168 Franklin Corner Road, Lawrenceville. For cohort 1 this is Thursday, October 15, 2026, from 10:00 am to 1:00 pm. There is no Teams link for the orientation. It is the only live session that week. Use the rest of the week to get your laptop and Moodle login working, and email us if you need help. Lessons start on Monday, October 19, and so do the weekly live sessions. Your first check-in is due by Sunday, October 25.
Weeks 1 to 5	The MMT core course. Four recorded lessons each week that you watch in Moodle at any time. Live sessions with your instructor, Marrein Agwaro: office hours Tuesday and Thursday, 10:00 am to 1:00 pm, on campus or on Teams. Friday on Teams: the career workshop from 10:00 to 11:30 am, then office hours to 1:00 pm. A check-in with staff every week. The week closes Sunday at 11:59 pm.
Weeks 6 and 7	The NJIT AI Literacy Microcredential, online at your own pace, with help at the same three live sessions, plus job club and one-on-one job help.
Cohort 1 dates	Day 0: Tuesday, October 6. Orientation: Thursday, October 15. Week 1: October 19 to 25. Week 2: October 26 to November 1. Week 3: November 2 to 8. Week 4: November 9 to 15. Week 5: November 16 to 22. Thanksgiving break: November 23 to 29, with no lessons and no office hours. Week 6: November 30 to December 4. Week 7: December 7 to 11. Last day: Friday, December 11, 2026. Week 8, if you need it: December 14 to 18.
Week 8	Only if you need more time to finish NJIT.
After you finish	We keep helping you find and keep a job. We check in with you 30, 60 and 90 days after you start work.

What we cover each week

- Week 1: Your laptop, Windows 11, Moodle, and your NJ Job Source account. You take the Northstar skills check (six modules, with a proctor) in the first two live sessions, Tuesday, October 20 and Thursday, October 22, 10:00 am to 1:00 pm, on campus or on Teams. If you miss them, you take it at the next live session.

- Week 2: Word, Excel and Google tools. You build a household budget.
- Week 3: Internet, email, video meetings and money tools online.
- Week 4: Online safety, scams, and how to use AI at work.
- Week 5: Your resume, cover letter, job search and interview practice. You take the Northstar check again.

3. Your week and your 20 hours

In weeks 1 to 5, your instructor, Marrein Agwaro, records each lesson. You watch it in Moodle when it fits your day, then read, practice and do the task. You can get help in person or online at office hours. Every week you also meet with staff for a short check-in.

Your week (weeks 1 to 5)

When	What happens	Where
Monday	The week opens. We post the week's four lessons and the check-in times.	Moodle
Any day	Watch the lessons, read, practice and do your tasks. Each lesson takes about 3 hours.	Moodle, on your laptop
Tuesday, 10:00 am to 1:00 pm	Office hours: get help, do your check-in, work in the lab.	Campus lab (Suite 140) or Teams
Thursday, 10:00 am to 1:00 pm	Office hours: get help, do your check-in, go over your weekly check.	Campus lab (Suite 140) or Teams
Friday, 10:00 to 11:30 am, then 11:30 am to 1:00 pm	The career workshop, then office hours.	Teams
Sunday, 11:59 pm	The week closes. Your tasks, practice and weekly check are due.	Moodle

These three blocks, led by your instructor, Marrein Agwaro (Eastern time), are the only scheduled live sessions. They start the week of October 19. The instructor may add extra sessions; they are announced in Moodle.

Your weekly check-in (required). Every week you meet with a staff member for 10 to 15 minutes. You can do it at office hours, on Teams, or by phone if that is the only way that week. Together you look at your progress in Moodle, your weekly check, anything in your way, and your plan for next week. You also fill in a short check-in form in Moodle with three questions. Next week's lessons open after you send the form.

Every week is 20 hours. This matters because WorkFirst NJ asks you to take part in approved activities for a set number of hours each week. Your county caseworker counts the hours you do here. MMT sends your hours to your caseworker every week.

Weeks 1 to 5

Type	Hours	When
Recorded lessons and practice with each lesson (4 lessons)	12	Any time in the week. The hours count when you turn in the lesson's task.
Office hours	up to 6	Tuesday and Thursday, 10:00 am to 1:00 pm, on campus or on Teams. Friday, 11:30 am to 1:00 pm, on Teams.
Weekly check-in	0.5	Once a week, at office hours, on Teams or by phone
Career services	2	The Friday career workshop on Teams, 10:00 to 11:30 am (1.5 hours), plus 30 minutes with your Career Services Advisor: a career check-in or a one-on-one meeting. If you miss the workshop, you meet one-on-one instead.
Moodle practice	2	On your own time, due Sunday at 11:59 pm
Total	**20**	

Office hours are your choice. They also help you reach 20 hours: without them, your week has 16.5 hours. At your check-in, we help you plan office-hours time or extra practice so your week reaches 20.

Weeks 6 and 7

Type	Hours	When
NJIT modules, online at your own pace	15	About one module each weekday. Get help with NJIT at the live sessions: Tuesday, Thursday and Friday, 10:00 am to 1:00 pm
Career services	3	Inside the live sessions: the Friday job club on Teams and a one-on-one meeting on Tuesday or Thursday
Office hours	2	Tuesday, Thursday or Friday, 10:00 am to 1:00 pm

Why your hours matter. Your hours count for WorkFirst NJ, so missed work can affect your county requirement. Each lesson also builds on the one before. To earn your MMT Certificate of Completion, you need at least 51 of the 60 core lesson hours (17 of the 20 lessons), on time or made up, and a check-in every week in weeks 1 to 5. We record your office-hours and check-in time to the minute.

If you know you will miss your check-in or fall behind, tell us by email or tell a staff member in person. If you miss your check-in, we send you a text the same day and call you the next day to help you plan.

4. How to reach us

- **Email:** contact@mercermedtech.com. Put your name and cohort in the subject line. We answer within one business day.
- **In person:** Mercer Med Tech, 168 Franklin Corner Rd, Bldg 2, Suite 140, Lawrenceville, NJ 08648.
- **Office hours:** Tuesday and Thursday, 10:00 am to 1:00 pm, on campus or on Teams. Friday, 11:30 am to 1:00 pm, on Teams, after the career workshop (10:00 to 11:30 am). These three blocks, led by your instructor, Marrein Agwaro (Eastern time), are the only scheduled live sessions. They start the week of October 19. The instructor may add extra sessions; they are announced in Moodle. The links are on the Class links page in Moodle.
- **Your Career Services Advisor** is your main contact for schedule changes, supports and job search help.

We send reminders the way you chose at orientation (text or email).

5. Your laptop and hotspot

Every participant gets a laptop from MMT after the IEP is signed. If your IEP shows that you do not have reliable internet at home, you also get a hotspot. Here is the short version of the rules:

- You sign an IT Asset Agreement. We write down the serial number and the condition of the laptop.
- You get the laptop, the charger and instructions.
- The laptop is on loan and belongs to MMT until you meet the two conditions below.
- Use it for training and your job search. Keep it charged and bring it to office hours on campus.
- Tell us within 48 hours if it is lost, stolen or damaged. We decide each case one at a time. If damage is more than normal wear, you may be asked to take responsibility for it.
- **The laptop becomes yours** when you (1) finish all the training in your IEP and (2) start a job within 90 days of finishing and are still working 90 days after you start. You do not need to pass the credential exam. If a job ends early, you have 30 days to start a new one, and the 90 days start again with the new job.
- Your Career Services Advisor checks your job at 30, 60 and 90 days. After the 90-day check, you sign a Laptop Ownership Transfer Form and the laptop is yours.
- Return the laptop if you leave the program before you finish, or if the job condition is not met. Return the hotspot when you start work or when you exit the program. We check the device with you and you sign a Return Confirmation Form.
- Your Moodle and Microsoft accounts close when you exit the program. We show you how to save your work to your own account before then.

The laptop shows Windows in English, because most employer systems are in English. It also has a Spanish keyboard. You will learn how to change the language in week 1.

6. Moodle basics

Moodle is our online classroom. Everything for the course is there, in English and Spanish.

- **Log in** with the username on your printed login card. You set your own password on the first day.
- **Start here** is the top section. It has news, the help page, your attendance and the glossary.
- **Each week** has its own section: the lesson videos, readings, your tasks, practice, the weekly check and your check-in form.
- **Tasks** are graded with three levels: Meets, Exceeds, or Not yet. "Not yet" means you get a short corrective task and a time at office hours within 48 hours, and you can try again until you reach Meets.
- **Practice** is four short items each week, about 30 minutes each. They count toward your 20 hours.
- **Language:** choose English or Spanish from the menu at the top.
- Moodle works on your phone, but do your practice on the laptop. That is the skill employers want.

7. Recorded lessons and office hours on Teams

- Watch each lesson in Moodle on your laptop. You can pause, go back and watch again. Captions are on.
- Each lesson also has a reading page and step cards in English and Spanish. If a lesson has a Spanish version or Spanish captions, you can choose it in Moodle.
- Join office hours on Teams with the link on the Class links page in Moodle. Use your full first name and last initial as your screen name.
- Use a quiet place if you can. Mute when you are not speaking.
- Turn your camera on when you can. It helps us help you, and it is practice for video interviews. If you cannot, tell the instructor.

- Use the chat or the "raise hand" button to ask a question. Every question helps.
- Be kind and respectful. We come from many backgrounds and speak different languages.
- Office hours and check-ins are not recorded. When you need to use a private account, like benefits or a bank, you do it on campus or on your own laptop, and staff do not look at your data.
- Never show or say your Social Security number, case number, EBT or bank card number, or date of birth in office hours or in a task. We give you a practice identity card for class tasks.

8. If you fall behind: make-up rules

- If a lesson's task is not turned in when the week closes on Sunday, make it up within 7 days.
- To make up a lesson, finish it (watch the video, read, and turn in the task), then come to a check-in. Staff go over the work with you.
- Make-up counts toward your certificate. The lesson's hours count in the week you turn in the task. Your county decides how late hours count toward your WorkFirst NJ hours.
- If you miss your check-in, do one before the next week opens.
- You can make up to 3 lessons (9 hours). If you need more, we meet with you to make a plan. One choice is to move to the same week of the next cohort, which starts 5 weeks later.

The full Attendance and Make-up Policy is a separate page that you sign at orientation.

9. Supportive services

We want to remove what gets in the way of training. Tell your Career Services Advisor what you need. Each support must match a need written in your IEP, and you sign a form for it.

- **Laptop and hotspot** from MMT (see section 5).
- **Transportation and child care:** we refer you to your county WorkFirst NJ caseworker, who can help during approved activities.
- **Accommodation for a disability:** ask the Program Director. Our campus is fully accessible. We offer large-print step cards, captions on videos and screen tools.
- **Other help:** we can refer you to counseling and community services.

MMT does not give cash or stipends.

10. Your privacy

- Your IEP, Digital Literacy Plan, case notes and forms are kept in a private, encrypted file. Only MMT program staff can open it.
- Moodle holds only your name, email, participant ID, language and cohort.
- Paper forms are scanned and kept in a locked cabinet.
- We keep records for 7 years, as the state requires, and share them only with NJDOL and as the law requires.
- When you need to use a real account, like your benefits or your bank, you do it privately. Staff do not look at or record your data.
- Never put private data into an AI tool. You will learn why in week 4.

11. What you leave with

- A Northstar skills report from the start and the end, so you can see your growth, plus Northstar certificates for modules you pass with a proctor.
- A resume, a cover letter, a household budget, a short slide talk, and a professional email to an employer.

- An NJ Job Source profile with your resume uploaded.
- The MMT Certificate of Completion.
- The **NJIT AI Literacy Microcredential (with Instruction)** when you finish the NJIT course, a college credential listed on the New Jersey Eligible Training Provider List.
- Job search help from your Career Services Advisor, for as long as you need it.

12. Concerns

If you have a concern or a complaint, talk to your Career Services Advisor or email the Program Director at contact@mercermedtech.com. Your rights and the complaint steps are also explained at orientation.

The funding for this initiative is being provided by the New Jersey Department of Labor and Workforce Development.